

Tomorrow's trends, today's **NEXT BIG THINGS.** New ideas from around the globe.

Eco-friendly Plastic



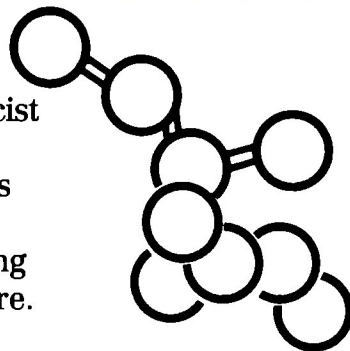
CHEMIST GEOFFREY COATES OF CORNELL UNIVERSITY DECIDED TO REINVENT PLASTIC, SO FAR ACCUSED OF POLLUTING THE PLANET. USING THE SIMPLE ORANGE RIND, HE HOPES TO REPLACE ALL THE TOXIC PLASTIC OUT THERE.

YouTube Activism

Robert Greenwald's Brave New Films focuses on short online political videos, and posts them on YouTube. It's a digital media revolution, at practically no cost. Millions watch the films at house parties and through independent online DVD sales.

Synthetic Biology

First coined by Polish geneticist Wacław Szybalski in 1974, controversies abound with its belief in engineering a body, one biobrick at a time, making it easy to understand and cure.



Conscious Democracy

Emerging in the past two years in the US, it marks the growing discomfort among the masses about the war in Iraq. A conscious democracy recognises that "the price of freedom is eternal vigilance".

Techno Impressionism

Created by Tony Karp in the early 1990s, it combines art and computer technology to produce new images. It's the last art movement of the 20th century, and the first of the 21st century.

Ecstatic Capitalism

ITS FOLLOWERS ARE EVERYWHERE AND INCLUDE EVERYONE. IT MIXES WORK AND PLAY, LABOUR AND PLEASURE.



Biology as Art

FROM AUSTRALIAN ARTIST STELARC, WHO IS GROWING AN EXTRA EAR SYNTHESISED FROM HIS OWN CELLS FOR EVENTUAL IMPLANTATION ON HIS ARM, TO EDUARDO KAC, THE CHICAGO ARTIST WHO COLLABORATED WITH FRENCH GENE JOCKEYS TO CREATE ALBA, AN ALBINO BUNNY WITH A JELLYFISH GENE THAT MAKES HER FLUORESCCE GREEN, IT'S AN ART FORM THAT MINES GENETICS.

Flarf Poetry



AN AVANT-GARDE LITERARY MOVEMENT SPARKED BY GARY SULLIVAN IN 2000. IS A CATCH-ALL TERM FOR COMPOSITIONS THAT USE SEARCH ENGINES.

DIY Technology

Increasing trend of people fiddling with their iPods, TiVos and Priuses to access new features. Requires not only a lot of ingenuity but a little bit of piracy as well.

Gross National Happiness (GNH)

A measure of the citizens' happiness and moral values, this index was introduced in 1972 by Bhutan's fourth king Singye Wangchuck. Going against traditional economic models, it rates prosperity through the amalgamation of spiritual and material values.



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